

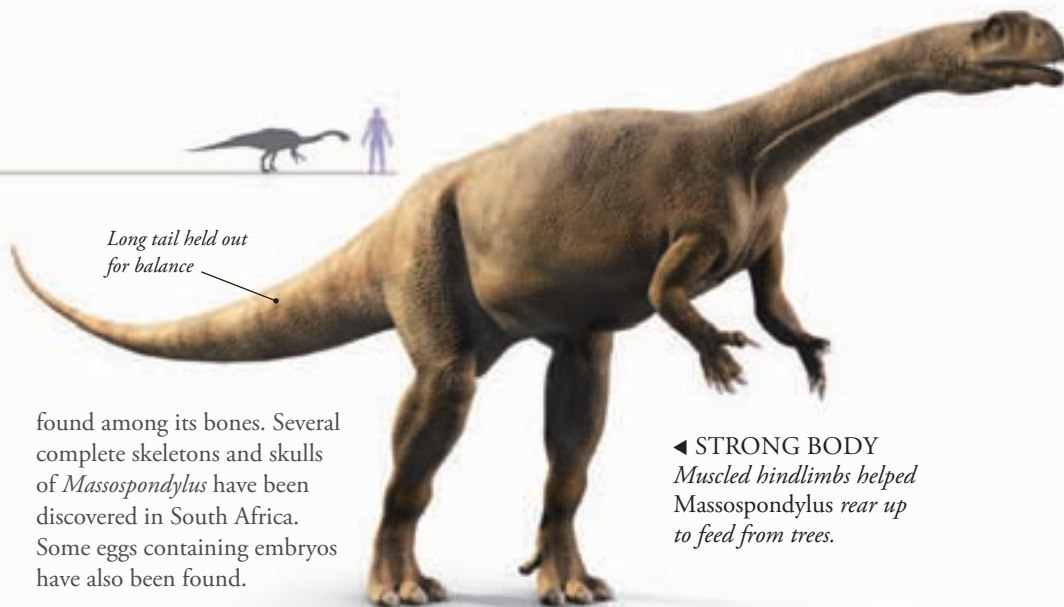
Massospondylus

MASS-oh-SPON-dill-us

- **When** 200–183 million years ago (Early Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** S. Africa
- **Habitat** Woodlands of S. Africa
- **Length** 13–20 ft (4–6 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Massospondylus had five-fingered hands, which it used to grasp and pull down branches. It may also have used its long thumb claws to tear off pieces of plant material. Small, coarse teeth suggest that it could chew both meat and plants. It may also have swallowed small stones to help digest its food, as many “stomach stones” have been

found among its bones. Several complete skeletons and skulls of *Massospondylus* have been discovered in South Africa. Some eggs containing embryos have also been found.



◀ **STRONG BODY**
Muscle hindlimbs helped Massospondylus rear up to feed from trees.

Thecodontosaurus

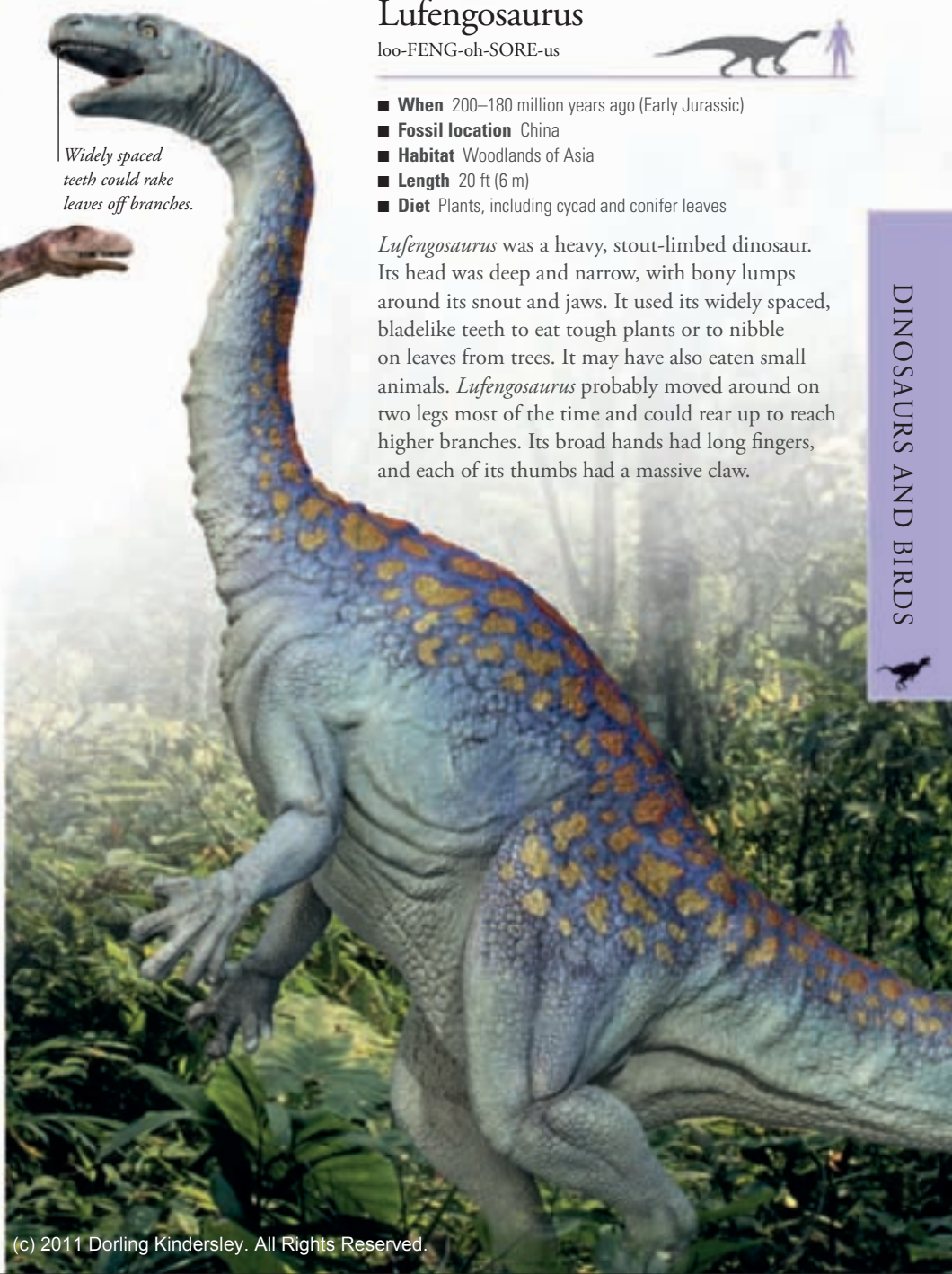
THEE-co-DON-toe-SORE-us

- **When** 225–208 million years ago (Late Triassic)
- **Fossil location** British Isles
- **Habitat** Wooded offshore islands of western Europe
- **Length** 7 ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Plants



Thecodontosaurus was the first prosauropod to be discovered, and was named “socket-toothed” after its unusual leaf-shaped, sawlike teeth. Unlike lizards today, whose teeth are fused to their jaw bones, this prosauropod’s teeth were rooted in separate sockets in its jaw bones. As it is smaller than its relatives, scientists think it may have lived on islands, since animals that live on islands are often small in size. Many fossils of *Thecodontosaurus* have been found in caves, and may have been washed there by rising sea levels.

Widely spaced teeth could rake leaves off branches.



Lufengosaurus

loo-FENG-oh-SORE-us

- **When** 200–180 million years ago (Early Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** China
- **Habitat** Woodlands of Asia
- **Length** 20 ft (6 m)
- **Diet** Plants, including cycad and conifer leaves

Lufengosaurus was a heavy, stout-limbed dinosaur. Its head was deep and narrow, with bony lumps around its snout and jaws. It used its widely spaced, blade-like teeth to eat tough plants or to nibble on leaves from trees. It may have also eaten small animals. *Lufengosaurus* probably moved around on two legs most of the time and could rear up to reach higher branches. Its broad hands had long fingers, and each of its thumbs had a massive claw.



DID YOU KNOW...?

During World War II, a bomb set fire to the Bristol City Museum in Britain, destroying a precious fossil kept in it. This fossil was of *Thecodontosaurus*—the oldest dinosaur ever found in Britain. Luckily, some bones were saved and can still be seen in the museum.

